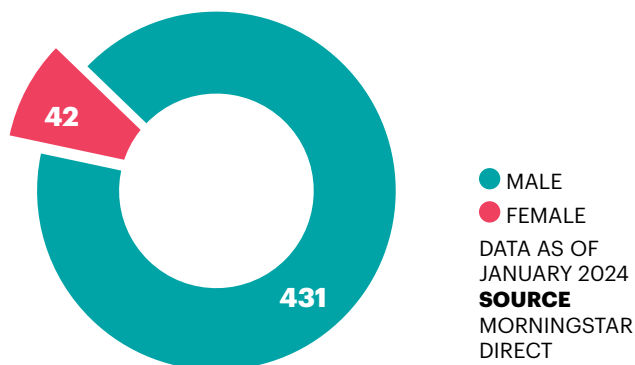


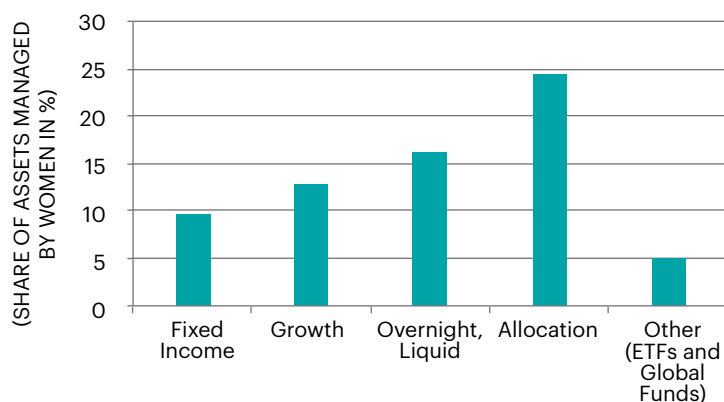
A WIDE GAP

- There are 42 women fund managers out of a total of 473 fund managers
- Five fund houses had three or more female fund managers, five others had two, and the rest had at least one female fund manager as of January 2024



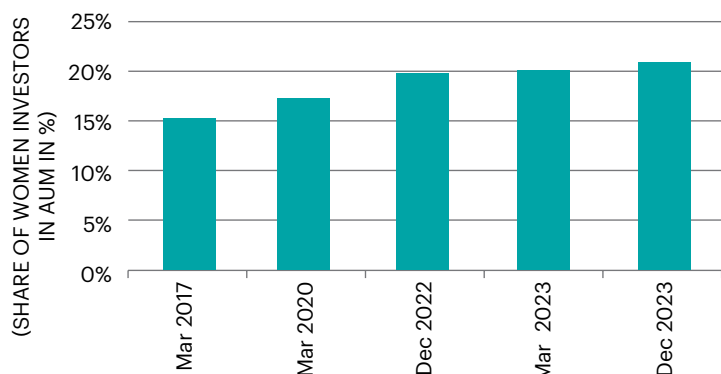
CATEGORY PERFORMANCE

- In the equity/growth asset class, women manage/co-manage ₹2.86 lakh crore of assets, which is the highest
- In terms of share within categories, the highest proportion of assets managed was in 'Allocation'



NOTE DATA AS OF JANUARY 2024 **SOURCE** MORNINGSTAR DIRECT

- Women investors' share in overall assets under management has seen a steady rise from 15.2% in March 2017 to nearly 21% in December 2023
- Their share has increased rapidly in the B30 or smaller cities, where it has risen from 17% to 28% over this period



SOURCE AMFI

Iyer, 48, began as a research analyst after her MBA from the Narsee Monjee Institute of Management Studies (NMIMS). She says she loved maths and language in school and got hooked on finance at NMIMS. At college events, she would be the treasurer and handle the accounts.

Iyer, who has been with the Kotak group for over two decades, says that market timings weren't regulated when she started her career in 1997, so managing work and family was a task.

She dismisses the term "work-life balance". "It is all about prioritising the right things at the right time... I haven't skipped a single PTM [parent-teacher meeting]," says Iyer.

Her passion for her work and some juggling with schedules kept her on track. "Though I was in the minority in the financial world, I constantly reminded myself that I am here because of my passion, and I had to keep going."

Before moving to Kotak's investment advisory business, Iyer was at Kotak Asset Management Company, handling more than ₹1 lakh crore of assets.

Devina Mehra, the 59-year-old Chairperson and Managing Director of wealth management firm First Global, says the big picture needs some tweaking. "Change is first required at the family and society level before we talk of any changes at the workplace," she says.

A gold medallist from IIM Ahmedabad, Mehra was the only woman at Citibank in investment banking. Today, she can teach fund managers a thing or two with her portfolio strategies. First Global's India Multi-Asset and The India Super 50 have delivered annualised returns of 19.76% and 27.84% to high net-worth investors (HNIs) since inception in February 2020.